

Most of us think of bugs as a variety of small creepy-crawlies, but when scientists talk about bugs, they are referring to a very specific type of insect called a "true bug." This **rainbow shield bug** is what they would call a "true bug."

WHAT IS A BUG?

A bug is a tiny animal with a giant family. You'll find bugs just about everywhere on the planet, from towering mountains and dry deserts, to your own backyard.

While many people think of bugs as just insects, some of their close relatives—other creatures in the arthropod family—are also known as bugs. Their wider family contains lots more amazing relatives, too. Bugs come in many different shapes and sizes, but what links all of these creatures together is that none of them have backbones; they are all invertebrates.

Bugs and their relatives are some of the most important creatures on the planet. Without them, our world would look completely different, and many types of plants and animals would disappear altogether.

Let's get up close and personal with these tiny beasts...

